

BENEFITS OF GETHSEMANE

* DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE

** DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO
TECHNICIAN

TEXT: Matthew 26:36-46 (NKJV) *“Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to the disciples, **“Sit here while I go and pray over there.”** ³⁷And He took with Him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and He began to be sorrowful and deeply distressed. ³⁸Then He said to them, **“My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with Me.”** ³⁹He went a little farther and fell on His face, and prayed, saying, **“O My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; nevertheless, not as I will, but as You will.”** ⁴⁰Then He came to the disciples and found them asleep, and said to Peter, **“What? Could you not watch with Me one hour?”** ⁴¹**“Watch and pray, lest you enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”** ⁴²Again, a second time, He went away and prayed, saying, **“O My Father, if this cup cannot pass away from Me unless I drink it, Your will be done.”** ⁴³And He came and found them asleep again, for their eyes were heavy. ⁴⁴So He left them, went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words. ⁴⁵Then He came to His disciples and said to them, **“Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold, the***

hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is being betrayed into the hands of sinners. ⁴⁶*“Rise, let us be going. See, My betrayer is at hand.”*

INTRO: Immediately preceding the scriptures in our text we find Judas, the treasurer, and disciple of Christ, betraying Jesus into the hands of the chief priests.

Judas sold Jesus to the chief priests for \$19.20, and I must ask you, what will you sell him for?

Jesus has his last supper with his disciples. It is at this supper that Jesus reveals Judas as a traitor. Jesus makes his disciples aware of the fact that they also will deny him. Notice what Peter says in verse 35

“Though I should die with thee, yet will I not deny thee.”

Verse 36 says, *“Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane.”* The meaning of the word **Gethsemane** is *“Oil press.”* The very meaning of the word Gethsemane, suggests a place of intense struggle. If Gethsemane is a place of intense struggle, what benefit could there possibly be in a place like that?

Three benefits of Gethsemane which we will look at today: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Gethsemane is a place of choice....
- Gethsemane is a place of intense struggle...

- Gethsemane is a place of great victory...

I. GETHSEMANE IS A PLACE OF CHOICE...

It was at Gethsemane that Jesus had to make a decision, to take the easy road or submit His will to the will of the Father. Even though Jesus was the Son of God, He had to bring His human will under subjection to the will of the Father, just like all other sons of God!

When teaching his disciples to pray, Jesus said, ***“Thy kingdom come, thy will be done in earth as it is in Heaven.”*** When He comes to the place called Gethsemane he is given the opportunity for practical application! We all have opportunities for practical application of submitting our will to the will of the Father! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** This is not easy but it is necessary!

I am sure that if it had been possible for sin to have been forgiven another way, other than Jesus giving his life, the human part of Jesus would have preferred it. But it was not possible so Jesus had to come to the place of allowing the will of the Father to be the authority. Hebrews 4:14-15 (NKJV) ***“Seeing then that we have a great High Priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. ¹⁵For we do not have a High Priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses,***

but was in all points tempted as we are, yet without sin.”

For those of you who do not know Christ, this service has become a Gethsemane for you. You are going to be called upon to make a decision about your eternal destiny! Will you make a good choice or a bad choice? **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

Before Moses died, he preached Israel a sermon on Gethsemane. Notice what he says. Deuteronomy 30:15-20 (NKJV) *“See, I have set before you today life and good, death and evil, ¹⁶“in that I command you today to love the LORD your God, to walk in His ways, and to keep His commandments, His statutes, and His judgments, that you may live and multiply; and the LORD your God will bless you in the land which you go to possess. ¹⁷“But if your heart turns away so that you do not hear, and are drawn away, and worship other gods and serve them, ¹⁸“I announce to you today that you shall surely perish; you shall not prolong your days in the land which you cross over the Jordan to go in and possess. ¹⁹“I call heaven and earth as witnesses today against you, that I have set before you life and death, blessing and cursing; therefore choose life, that both you and your descendants may live; ²⁰“that you may love the LORD your God, that you may obey His voice, and that you may cling to Him, for He is your life and the length*

of your days; and that you may dwell in the land which the LORD swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, to give them.”

Moses informs Israel that when God brings them to a place of decision, it is not something to be trifled with, it is the difference between: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Life and death!
- Good and evil!
- Blessing and cursing!

Today is the day of salvation, now is the time your decision must be made. What will it be? You have reached Gethsemane!

In making your choice at Gethsemane, if you choose to make Jesus your Lord, there is something you must consider that Jesus said about your decision. Matthew 16:24 (NKJV) ***“If anyone desires to come after Me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow Me.”***

- Deny, according to Webster, is “*To refuse, to give in.*” Deny in the Greek means “*To disown or abstain.*”
- Cross in the Greek means “*A pole as an instrument of capital punishment.*”
- Follow in the Greek means “*Exactly, circumspectly, diligently, or perfectly.*”

The Don Nordin translation is: *“If any man will come after me, let him refuse to give in to the flesh, let him disown himself, let him crucify the flesh and let him walk circumspectly or perfectly after me.”* **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

It is certainly possible, but not always easy to do what Jesus is suggesting here. But when you fall in love with Jesus, your desire will be to please him! It's not nearly as difficult to live for God, when you love Him and have a made up mind to serve Him!

Every person in the Kingdom of God has been in the place you are walking through today, a place of decision, please make a good choice!

II. GETHSEMANE IS A PLACE OF INTENSE STRUGGLE...

Jesus himself found Gethsemane to be a place of intense struggle. Luke 22:44 (NKJV) *“Being in agony, He prayed more earnestly. Then His sweat became like great drops of blood falling down to the ground.”* The very meaning of the word *“Gethsemane”* depicts a struggle; the meaning is *“oil press.”* **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

The world is reeling from an intense struggle as we sit in this house of worship this morning. As Christians, we are in warfare as well. Ephesians 6:12 (NKJV)

“For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places.” A closer study of this verse reveals the writer is speaking of four classifications of demonic forces which are at work in the world today. We are in the struggle of our life, this is not a game! This is war!

On that night in Gethsemane, if the disciples could have peered into the spiritual world, they would not have gone to sleep; they would have been frightened out of their minds! Our lord was wrestling against all kinds of evil forces! He was in the true sense of the word, having an intense struggle!

In our Christian walk we will encounter times when we will walk through Gethsemane, that place of intense struggle! We have all been there when the light at the end of the tunnel turned out to be an oncoming train!

David described his Gethsemane this way, Psalm 23:4 (NKJV) ***“Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil; For You are with me.”*** We should always remember that when we are walking through a personal Gethsemane, the Lord is with us! David continues on. Psalms 23:5 (KJV) ***“Thou prepares a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: Thou***

anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.”

Remember God can turn our wilderness into a place where water is standing in pools!

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT

SLIDE) Don't fret because of the struggle at Gethsemane; God is working on our behalf! 1 John 4:4 (KJV) ***“Ye are of God, little children, and have overcome them: because greater is he that is in you, than he that is in the world.”***

Bible characters who walked through a place of intense struggle: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Abraham...
- Noah...
- Paul...

If we are going to follow God and perform the will of God with our lives, we can rest assured there is a struggle ahead. It will not always be easy, but the scripture says, Psalm 84:6 (NKJV) ***“Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee; in whose heart are the ways of them. ‘Who passing through the valley of Baca make it a well; the rain also filleth the pools.”***

When we walk through Gethsemane we can push the panic button or we can allow it to become a well for us, a place of growing, learning, and a place of dependence upon the Lord as our source.

III. GETHSEMANE IS A PLACE OF GREAT VICTORY...

At Gethsemane Jesus won the victory over the flesh, so that he could submit to the agony of the cross and severe torture at the hands of cruel men! When Jesus was on the cross, all He had to do was to say the word and God would have sent angels to set Him free!

Jesus knew what He would face on crucifixion day so He chose to confront the flesh ahead of time. It was at Gethsemane, even before the real battle was fought, that the victory was won. This is the reason he was able to endure the things that befell him.

So it is with us many times, we have to make a choice, struggle with the flesh; get the victory over these things; then fight the battle which has already been won. Yes, [the battle against evil has already been won for us, all we have to do is decide to follow Jesus,](#) **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** overcome the flesh and we are winners, not losers-Winners!

Look at the authority of the believer. Ephesians 1:19-23 (NKJV) ***“What is the exceeding greatness of His power toward us who believe, according to the working of His mighty power ²⁰which He worked in Christ when He raised Him from the dead and seated Him at His right hand in the heavenly places, ²¹far above all principality and power and might and***

dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this age but also in that which is to come. ²²And He put all things under His feet, and gave Him to be head over all things to the church, ²³which is His body, the fullness of Him who fills all in all.”

Ephesians 2:1-7 (NKJV) “And you He made alive, who were dead in trespasses and sins, ²in which you once walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit who now works in the sons of disobedience, ³among whom also we all once conducted ourselves in the lusts of our flesh, fulfilling the desires of the flesh and of the mind, and were by nature children of wrath, just as the others. ⁴But God, who is rich in mercy, because of His great love with which He loved us, ⁵even when we were dead in trespasses, made us alive together with Christ (by grace you have been saved), ⁶and raised us up together, and made us sit together in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, ⁷that in the ages to come He might show the exceeding riches of His grace in His kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.”

Romans 8:31-39 (NKJV) “What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? ³²He who did not spare His own Son, but delivered Him up for us all, how shall He not with Him also freely give us all things? ³³Who shall bring a charge against God’s elect? It is God who justifies. ³⁴Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, and

furthermore is also risen, who is even at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us.
³⁵Who shall separate us from the love of Christ?
Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? ³⁶As it is written: "For Your sake we are killed all day long; We are accounted as sheep for the slaughter." ³⁷Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us. ³⁸For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come, ³⁹nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord."

For Jesus, Gethsemane became a place of great victory because He made His decision to die on the cross the night before He was crucified! Hebrews 12:2 (NKJV)
"Looking unto Jesus, the author and finisher of our faith, who for the joy that was set before Him endured the cross, despising the shame, and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God."

CONCLUSION:

Here we are Gethsemane today; [will this prove to be a place of great victory or defeat in your life?](#) **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

